

BRAND IDENTITY

Zerado – Brand Manual

An object from 1984, built for 2030

Brand identity system · sistema de identidade visual

FlowForge ENGINEERED ARTIFACT		DRAWING TITLE Zerado – Brand Manual An object from 1984, built for 2030		
DISCIPLINE BRAND IDENTITY	SHEET 01 OF 13	DWG NO. ZRD-BRAND-01	REV A · 2026-08-24	STATUS ● IN REVIEW

LEGEND ■ Ink — text & headings □ Canvas — surface ■ Accent — emphasis ■ Highlight — rules

FlowForgeSoft · zerado.app · Version 1.0 · Revision A

This manual is the governing document for Zerado’s visual identity. Every colour value, type size and motion curve in it exists as a token in `tokens.css` and `tokens.json` in this same directory. **Those files are the implementation; this document is the reasoning.** Where the two disagree, the tokens are what ships — and the disagreement is a bug to file, not a judgement call to make at the keyboard.

Every contrast ratio printed here was **computed**, not estimated. Every terminal colour index was **derived** by nearest-neighbour search in CIELAB, not eyeballed. Where a number is tight, it says so.

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§01 1 • The brand idea

Zerado is a terminal-first game-library tracker. It reads everything you own, sorts it by **mood** rather than genre, watches the price against the all-time low, and answers one question: *what should I play tonight?* It is the second product from FlowForgeSoft.

The identity has one job: to look like **an expensive object from 1984 that was designed for 2030.**

The governing principle – the DeLorean and KITT

Two objects define the register, and they make the same argument. The **DeLorean DMC-12** (1981–83) is brushed stainless, unpainted, gull-winged — in a decade of paint and plastic it refused to look like its own decade. The **Knight Industries Two Thousand** (1982) is a black Trans Am whose interior is the real statement: a wraparound cockpit of amber readouts, a machine that talks back, and a single red light sweeping across a dark nose.

Neither is nostalgic. Both are **the eighties' own idea of tomorrow** — and that is the target. Neon, CRT glow, grid horizon, extruded and chromed type, scanner sweep, amber and red readouts, the precision of machined metal.

The bar, stated so it can be failed

*Retro-future, never retro-nostalgia. A faded, dusty, VHS-degraded, sepia, scanline-scratched, "remember the eighties?" treatment is a **MISS** — not a variation, not a stylistic alternative, not a debate. No distressed textures, no fake tape damage, no torn-poster edges, no nostalgia-kitsch.*

*The eighties in this brand are **new**. The object has just been unboxed. It is clean, it is lit, and it is pointed forward.*

Zerado is a **text program** — the oldest surviving form of software — with **native phone apps** coming later: the old form and the new form in one product. The brand is that argument rendered visually. When a decision is genuinely close, the tiebreak is *which option makes the product's own argument more clearly?*

The three things the identity must survive

This brand faces a constraint most brands never do, and it shaped the palette from the first decision rather than being checked at the end: **a terminal emulator**, where colour is an index in a 256-entry table that may collapse to 16 or be switched off entirely; **WCAG 2.2 AA**, where saturated neon on black is a minefield rather than a free win; and **colour-vision deficiency**, which affects roughly 1 in 12 men — a meaningful share of an audience of developers and sysadmins.

Nothing here was designed and then tested. It was designed *against* those three constraints, and where a beautiful choice failed one, the choice changed. \$4.5 records one such change.

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§02 2 • The name

Zerado is Portuguese for a game **beaten — finished, cleared, 100%'d**. The word comes from arcade cabinets: the score counter running past its last digit and rolling back to zero. That origin is **literally an eighties artifact**, and it is the source of the mark.

The word is also a **status inside the product**. That is deliberate: a tool named after the act it exists to enable explains itself the first time you use it.

OBJECT	FORM		OBJECT	FORM
The product, in prose	Zerado		The status, in prose	zerado (italic on first use)
The command, binary, domain, code	zerado		The status, in the interface	ZERADO
The wordmark	ZERADO			

The full rationale — why it won, the two runners-up, the three accepted risks and the collision check — is in **naming.md**, which is part of this manual and carries the same authority.

§03 3 • The logo

3.1 The idea

The mark is **an arcade counter rolled back to zero, with a scanner light travelling through its slot** — one glyph carrying both reference objects and the name at once. The **zero** is the name and the arcade origin of the name. The **slot with a travelling red light** is KITT's scanner, and it is the brand's one signature motion (§7.1). The **rounded-rectangle skeleton** is a digital counter's readout cell, not a circle — the difference between a machine's zero and a typographic one.

3.2 Construction

Drawn on a **64 × 64** grid. All values are grid units.

ELEMENT	GEOMETRY	VALUE
Counter ring	rounded rect, <code>x14 y9 w36 h46 rx12</code> , stroked	stroke 10
Ring outer bounds		46 × 56 (aspect 0.82)
Counter aperture	the hole	26 × 36
Scanner track	rounded rect, <code>x22 y28.5 w20 h7 rx3.5</code>	height 7
Scanner pip	rounded rect, <code>x30 y28.5 w9 h7 rx3.5</code>	width 9

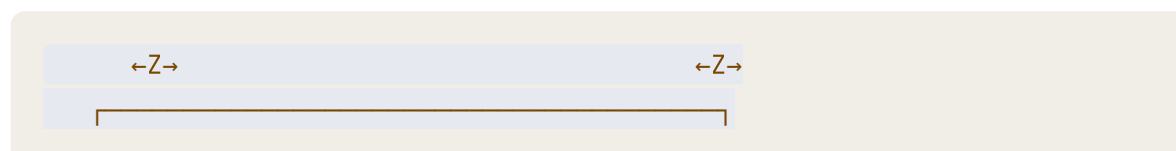
Two rules make the lockup a system rather than an assembly:

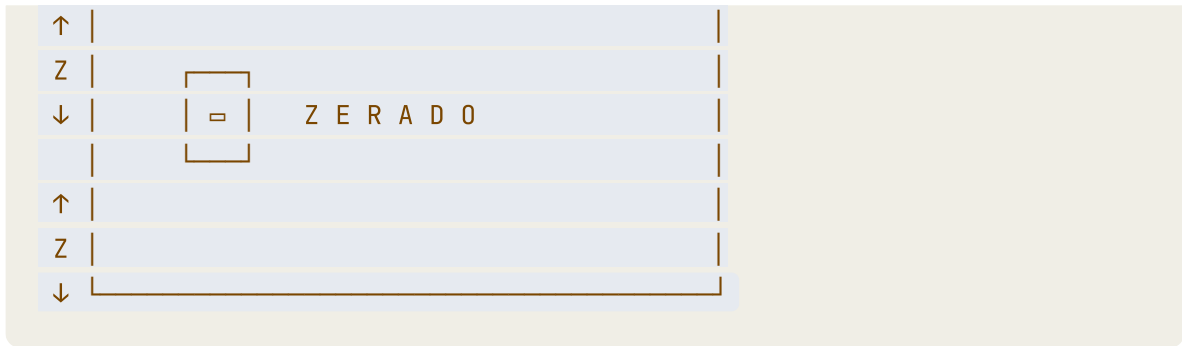
1. **The ring is taller than it is wide (0.82).** A square ring reads as a button or a warning lamp. The vertical proportion is what makes it a *zero*.
2. **The mark is the wordmark's 0.** The final letter of `ZERADO` is drawn on the same rounded-rectangle skeleton at the same proportion (0.79). Mark and logotype are one shape at two scales. **This rhyme is the lockup's whole logic and must not be broken by redrawing either half independently.**

The wordmark is **constructed geometry, not set type** — stroked paths, uniform stroke 9, butt caps, round joins, cap height 48 — so the logo carries no font dependency and no licensing question. It is *related* to Orbitron but is not Orbitron, and must never be re-set in a typeface. Letterspacing is **optically corrected, not mechanical**: the open-flanked `A` tightens against its neighbours and the round `0` opens slightly. Even mechanical advances are visibly wrong.

3.3 Clear space

Clear space equals the cap height of the logotype — 48 grid units, written here as `Z` — on all four sides.





Nothing enters this box — not text, not a rule, not another logo, not the edge of a photograph, not a container border. In a header it is measured from the artwork, not from the container padding.

3.4 Minimum sizes — tested, not assumed

Every size below was **rasterised in a browser at the stated pixel size and inspected**. These are measured floors, not conventions copied from another manual.

ASSET	MINIMUM	WHAT WAS VERIFIED
Full lockup	120 px wide	All six letters separate and legible
Mark alone (<code>logo-mark.svg</code>)	18 px	Ring, aperture and red slot all present
Mark, absolute floor	16 px	Reads as a zero with a lit slot; pip and track merge into one dash
Favicon (<code>favicon.svg</code>)	16 px	Simplified geometry — see below
Print	10 mm wide (mark)	

*Why **favicon.svg** is drawn differently. At 16 px the track/pip distinction is 1.75 px tall and collapses. The favicon drops the two-part scanner for a **single solid red bar**, thickens the ring, and adds a dark plate so it holds on light and dark browser chrome alike. Rendered side by side at 16 px the simplified favicon is visibly stronger. This is the only sanctioned redraw of the mark.*

3.5 The terminal mark

The identity has to survive where there is no vector renderer at all.

FORM	CELLS	USE
[0]	3 × 1	The mark. The terminal minimum.
[0] ZERADO	10 × 1	The lockup, for splash and <code>--help</code> headers.
0	1 × 1	Absolute floor — a status bar with no room.

Drawn with `--z-amber` on the brackets and glyph. Never as multi-row ASCII art: it breaks on resize, on narrow terminals, and in any log capture.

3.6 Colour variants

FILE	USE
logo.svg	Primary. Full colour, dark backgrounds. The default.
logo-mark.svg	Mark alone, transparent, square-safe. Avatars, app icons.
logo-mono-white.svg	One colour, white. Dark, photographic or printed grounds.
logo-mono-black.svg	One colour, black. Light grounds, fax, single-colour print.
favicon.svg	Browser tab. Plated, simplified, 16 px-proof.

In the mono variants the scanner **track and pip merge into one solid bar** — a barred zero. That is the correct degrade: readable in a single ink, with no knockouts and no transparency tricks.

Full colour requires a dark ground. Amber-and-red on white is out of register with the brand and loses the CRT logic entirely; on light backgrounds use `logo-mono-black.svg`.

3.7 Never

Each of these is a real failure mode, not a generic warning.

- **Never re-set the wordmark in a typeface** — including Orbitron. It is drawn geometry; setting it in type breaks the `0`-to-mark rhyme (§3.2).
- **Never scale the mark and the wordmark independently.**
- **Never put the full-colour logo on a light or photographic background.**
- **Never add glow, bevel, drop shadow, gradient or 3-D extrusion to the logo.** CRT bloom belongs to *interface* elements (§4.7); the logo stays flat. An extruded chrome logo is precisely the nostalgia-kitsch \$! rules out.
- **Never recolour the scanner pip.** It is `--z-scanner` and nothing else; making it cyan spends the brand’s rarest colour (§4.1) on decoration.
- **Never stretch, condense, rotate or skew** any part.
- **Never rebuild the mark as a perfect circle.** It is a counter cell.
- **Never place anything inside the clear space** (§3.3).
- **Never animate the ring.** Only the pip moves, only along its track.

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§04 4 · The colour system

4.1 The idea: one colour is common, one is earned

The palette carries product meaning, not just aesthetics. **Amber is the ambient voice** — the phosphor readout, the colour the machine speaks in constantly: headings, the mark, anything running. It is everywhere, and it is meant to be.

Cyan is earned. Reserved for **completion** — the **ZERADO** state — and for the single most important call to action on a screen. It is the colour of the thing the product exists to let you do, so it is spent rarely and never decoratively. A screen with cyan in five places has thrown away the only signal the palette has.

Red is motion and alarm only — the scanner sweep, destructive confirmations, errors; never body text, never a decorative accent. **Chrome is structure** — brushed stainless for text and for the dormant state. Target distribution on any surface: **60 % chassis (the blue-blacks) · 30 % chrome · 10 % amber**, with cyan measured in single elements, not percentages.

4.2 Roles and values

Measured against **--z-surface** (■ #0B0D14) unless noted. **AAA** = 7:1+, **AA** = 4.5:1+ for body text.

ROLE	TOKEN	HEX	RATIO	GRADE
Page ground	--z-bg	■ #05060A	—	—
Surface	--z-surface	■ #0B0D14	—	—
Raised surface	--z-surface-raised	■ #141A24	—	—
Overlay surface	--z-surface-overlay	■ #1D2532	—	—
Primary text	--z-text	□ #E9EEF5	16.65	AAA
Secondary text	--z-text-secondary	■ #A9B5C7	9.36	AAA
Tertiary text	--z-text-tertiary	■ #8492A8	6.15	AA
Primary (amber)	--z-primary	■ #FFB000	10.59	AAA
Primary hover	--z-primary-hover	■ #FFC94D	12.68	AAA
On-primary text	--z-primary-contrast	■ #05060A	11.05 on amber	AAA
Accent (cyan)	--z-accent	■ #19E0FF	12.15	AAA
On-accent text	--z-accent-contrast	■ #05060A	12.68 on cyan	AAA
Link	--z-text-link	■ #19E0FF	12.15	AAA
Hairline	--z-border	■ #2A3342	1.53	decorative only

ROLE	TOKEN	HEX	RATIO	GRADE
UI boundary	--z-border-strong	 #64748B	4.08	passes 1.4.11
Focus ring	--z-focus-ring	 #19E0FF	12.15	AAA
Scanner	--z-scanner	 #FF2E2E	5.25	motion/alarm, not text
Error text	--z-scanner-300	 #FF6B6B	6.99	AA

The three pairs the brand explicitly guarantees:

PURPOSE	PAIR	RATIO	REQUIREMENT
Body text	 #E9EEF5 on  #0B0D14	16.65:1	4.5:1 → AAA
Large display text	 #FFB000 on  #05060A	11.05:1	3:1 → AAA
Interactive / focus	 #19E0FF on  #0B0D14	12.15:1	3:1 → AAA

The worst text pair in the entire system is `--z-text-tertiary` on `--z-surface-overlay` at **4.89:1** — still AA. There is no failing text pair in the palette, by construction: where one appeared, the colour was changed rather than the pairing permitted.

Two rules that are not negotiable. `--z-border` is **decorative** — at 1.53:1 it may draw a hairline between blocks of content, but never mark the edge of an input, a button, or any control whose boundary carries meaning; those use `--z-border-strong`, which measures $\geq 3.24:1$ against every surface and satisfies WCAG 1.4.11. And **the focus ring is never removed** — 2 px with 2 px offset, on every interactive element, in every state. A keyboard-first audience is the launch audience; removing focus rings for aesthetics would be a self-inflicted wound on exactly the people the product is for.

4.3 The four game states

The **most-used visual system in the product** — every row of every list.

The co-render rule: colour AND glyph AND label. Every state carries all three; remove any one and the state is still unambiguous. This is not a concession to accessibility, it is what makes the system survive `NO_COLOR`, a monochrome terminal, a screenshot in a bug report, and colour-blind users, all by one mechanism.

STATE	COLOUR	HEX	GLYPH	ASCII	LABEL	RATIO
Not started	chrome	 #A5A29B	 U+25CB	[]	NOT STARTED	7.62
In progress	amber	 #FFB000	 U+25D0	[~]	IN PROGRESS	10.59
Zerado	cyan	 #19E0FF	 U+25C9	[*]	ZERADO	12.15

STATE	COLOUR	HEX	GLYPH	ASCII	LABEL	RATIO
Abandoned	orchid	 #C77DFF	 U+2298	[x]	ABANDONED	7.21

The glyphs are a **single visual progression** — an empty ring, a ring half filled, a ring with a solid core, a ring struck through — so the sequence reads as a story even in one ink. **Zerado** takes the cyan because cyan is the earned colour and because a filled core is the strongest glyph in the set: the state the product is named after is the one that looks like an achievement.

4.4 Colour-vision deficiency – how this was verified

Method. Each state colour was simulated for protanopia and deuteranopia with the **Viénot, Brettel & Mollon (1999)** dichromat model in linear RGB, then all six pairs were measured for separation as **CIEDE2000** in CIELAB. Reference targets are the Bang Wong and Paul Tol colour-blind-safe palettes.

VISION	WORST PAIR	ΔE_{2000}
Normal	not-started × zerado	28.2
Protanopia	not-started × zerado	23.7
Deuteranopia	zerado × abandoned	11.9

$\Delta E \geq 10$ is distinct; ≥ 15 is comfortable. **Every pair clears 10 in every model.** The tightest — cyan against orchid under deuteranopia at 11.9 — is the one place where glyph and label genuinely carry load rather than merely reinforce. That is what they are there for.

The change this testing forced. The first draft used a blue-cast steel grey ( #9FB0C6) for not started — the obvious choice beside a blue-black chassis. Simulated, it collapsed against the cyan at ΔE 8.8 under deuteranopia: two states that would look nearly identical to roughly 1 in 12 male users, on the most-used component in the product.

*It was replaced with a **warm** brushed grey,  #A5A29B, measuring 25.8 — a 2.9x improvement. The warmth is load-bearing engineering, not taste, and must not be “corrected” back toward blue. It is also more accurate: brushed stainless is warm-neutral. The constraint and the reference agreed.*

4.5 The paper expression

Zerado is dark-native, but the manual prints, the PDF renders on a white page, and some contexts are simply light. Rather than let those fall back to a generic palette, the brand has a **second designed expression**.

ROLE	SCREEN	PAPER	RATIO ON PAPER
Ground	 #05060A	 #F3F5F8	—
Ink	 #E9EEF5	 #0B0D14	17.77 AAA
Ink soft	 #A9B5C7	 #39434F	9.20 AAA
Ink muted	 #8492A8	 #5E6A7A	5.04 AA
Amber	 #FFB000	 #965600	5.30 AA
Amber strong	—	 #7A4600	7.11 AAA
Cyan	 #19E0FF	 #0A6070	6.58 AA
Scanner	 #FF2E2E	 #C61F1F	5.32 AA

These are not different colours; they are **the same hues carried to ink weight** — measured, the paper amber sits **9.7°** from the screen amber in CIELAB hue and the paper cyan **3.1°** from the screen cyan. It still reads as Zerado because it *is* Zerado.

The paper values are exposed in `tokens.css` §9 under the unprefixed names the PDF renderer resolves (`--ink` , `--canvas` , `--accent` , `--font-display` and siblings). That mapping is what makes a Zerado document print **in Zerado’s brand**, and it is scoped so it cannot alter the dark default.

4.6 Glow

CRT bloom is available and used **sparingly** — a focused input, a hovered primary action, the scanner track: `--z-glow-amber` / `--z-glow-cyan` / `--z-glow-red` , a tight 1 px colour ring plus a soft short-radius bloom. It is not a drop shadow, it is never stacked, it never appears on more than one element on screen at a time, and per §3.7 it never touches the logo.

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§05 5 • Colour in the terminal

Zerado is a TUI first. A palette that only exists as hex is only half a palette.

5.1 Three representations

Every brand colour resolves three ways. The ANSI-256 indices were **derived** by nearest-neighbour search against the xterm 256-colour cube, measured as CIEDE2000 in CIELAB — not chosen by eye.

TOKEN	HEX	ANSI-256	ΔE	16-COLOUR	SURVIVES 16?
Surface	 #0B0D14	232	3.8	black	yes
Raised surface	 #141A24	234	6.7	black	merges with surface
Text	 #E9EEF5	255	3.7	bright white	yes
Secondary text	 #A9B5C7	249	8.5	white	yes
UI boundary	 #64748B	67	9.3	bright black	yes
Amber	 #FFB000	214	0.4	bright yellow	yes
Cyan	 #19E0FF	45	3.4	bright cyan	yes
Chrome	 #A5A29B	247	3.9	white	yes
Orchid	 #C77DFF	177	3.8	bright magenta	yes
Scanner	 #FF2E2E	9	5.3	bright red	yes

The amber match is **near-exact at ΔE 0.4** — xterm 214 is  #FFAF00 against the brand's  #FFB000. The brand's primary colour is already a terminal colour.

5.2 The 16-colour floor

At 16 colours the four states resolve to **four distinct slots**: not started → white (7), in progress → bright yellow (11), zerado → bright cyan (14), abandoned → bright magenta (13). No collisions — the state system is fully functional at the lowest depth a terminal offers.

What is lost, stated honestly: the surface ramp flattens, since `--z-surface` and `--z-surface-raised` both become **black**. Elevation must therefore be carried by borders and spacing, never by fill. Design terminal layouts so they never depend on surface fill to separate regions.

5.3 Backgrounds the palette must hold

Users bring their own theme. Worst case across the four state colours:

BACKGROUND	WORST STATE RATIO
Pure black  #000000	7.81

BACKGROUND	WORST STATE RATIO
xterm dark grey  #1C1C1C	6.33
Solarized Dark  #002B36	5.58
Gruvbox Dark  #282828	5.48
One Dark  #282C34	5.20

Every state colour clears AA body text (4.5:1) on every one of them. The palette does not require the user to adopt the brand’s background.

5.4 NO_COLOR

Zerado honours NO_COLOR (no-color.org). When set, the product emits no SGR sequences at all — not a reduced palette, not a “safe” subset. Zero.

What the identity degrades to: everything. The four states remain fully distinct through glyph and label, which is the entire reason the co-render rule exists:

○	NOT STARTED	Hollow Knight	41h
◐	IN PROGRESS	Outer Wilds	12h
●	ZERADO	Return of the Obra Dinn	9h
◑	ABANDONED	Sekiro	3h

Structure is then carried by box-drawing characters, spacing, and the hierarchy of a monospaced grid. A Zerado screen with colour stripped is not a degraded Zerado screen — it is a correct one. The same applies to forced-colors: active on the web, by the same mechanism. Where a Unicode glyph cannot be relied on, the ASCII column of §4.3 ([] [~] [*] [x]) is the fallback.

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\$06 6 • Typography

6.1 The three families

Three faces, three jobs, and a hard rule about which does what. **All three are SIL Open Font License 1.1** — free for commercial use, self-hostable, legally shippable. The site self-hosts all three; there is no external CDN.

ROLE	FAMILY	LICENCE	SOURCE	AXES
Display	Orbitron	SIL OFL 1.1 (RFN "Orbitron"), Matt McInerney	github.com/googlefonts/orbitron-vf	wght 400–900
Voice	Space Grotesk	SIL OFL 1.1, Florian Karsten	github.com/floriankarsten/space-grotesk	wght 300–700
Native tongue	JetBrains Mono	SIL OFL 1.1, JetBrains	github.com/JetBrains/JetBrainsMono	wght 100–800

Orbitron carries the era — a square geometric face drawn explicitly as display type "for the future", the closest freely-licensable equivalent to the wide, high-waisted geometric capitals of eighties corporate-future lettering. It is why a headline reads as 1984 rather than 2016.

Orbitron is display-only, and this is a hard rule. Never below 23 px, never for prose, never more than about eight words, always uppercase, always tracked out. Orbitron as body copy is unreadable and instantly reads as a games-console UI — the wrong eighties.

Space Grotesk is the voice — a proportional face derived from Space Mono, so technical by heritage and able to pair with a monospace without looking accidental. It carries every sentence in the product and on the site. It was chosen over a fully neutral face (Inter) because neutrality would have made Orbitron look like a costume; Space Grotesk shares enough character to make the pairing read as one voice at two volumes.

JetBrains Mono is the native tongue. The product is a terminal application, so monospace is not a code-block afterthought — it is **a first-class text role** and the sound of the product itself. It sets every command, path, hours-played figure, price and state label, and above all the **readout style**: the small tracked-out uppercase label that heads sections and mimics a cockpit annotation. That role is what carries the KITT reference into typography.

6.2 The ramp

Root 16 px. All values are tokens in [tokens.css](#) \$5.

STEP	SIZE	LINE HEIGHT	FAMILY	WEIGHT	TRACKING	CASE
Display	76 px	1.02	Orbitron	700	0.04em	UPPER
H1	52 px	1.08	Orbitron	700	0.03em	UPPER
H2	34 px	1.22	Orbitron	600	0.02em	UPPER
H3	23 px	1.22	Space Grotesk	700	0	Sentence
Body large	19 px	1.60	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence
Body	17 px	1.65	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence
Body small	15 px	1.60	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence
Caption	13 px	1.50	Space Grotesk	400	0	Sentence
Readout	13 px	1.20	JetBrains Mono	500	0.18em	UPPER

Display and H1 are fluid — `clamp()` tokens hold them between 44 px and 76 px so a long headline never overflows a phone. **The governing relationship:** as size increases, line-height tightens and tracking opens. Wide tracking on large capitals is the eighties-future signature; tight tracking on body text would simply hurt.

6.3 Rules

- **17 px is the floor for prose** — never smaller, anywhere, for anything a visitor is expected to read as a sentence.
- **Body line-height is 1.65**, above the WCAG 1.4.12 minimum of 1.5.
- **Maximum three weights per family** on any one surface.
- **Measure caps at 68 characters** (`--z-measure`).
- **Left-aligned always.** Never justify — it opens rivers and fights the monospaced grid the product's own screens are built on.
- **Never set body text in Orbitron** (§6.1), and **never set all-caps paragraphs** — capitals are for display, readout labels, state chips and buttons only.

7.1 The scanner sweep – the signature

One motion belongs to this brand: **a single light travelling across a dark track**, taken directly from KITT. It appears on the hero, as a section divider, as an indeterminate progress indicator, and inside the mark at display size.

PROPERTY	VALUE	TOKEN
Track height	2 px	<code>--z-scanner-track-h</code>
Track colour	 <code>#5C1414</code> ( <code>#6E1818</code> in the mark)	<code>--z-scanner-track</code>
Pip width	18 % of track	<code>--z-scanner-pip-width</code>
Pip colour	 <code>#FF2E2E</code>	<code>--z-scanner</code>
Travel	left edge → right edge – pip width	
Full cycle	2400 ms (1200 ms each direction)	<code>--z-duration-scanner</code>
Easing	<code>cubic-bezier(0.45, 0, 0.55, 1)</code>	<code>--z-ease-scanner</code>
Direction	<code>alternate</code> , <code>infinite</code>	

Why that easing. KITT's scanner was a physically oscillating mirror, and a real oscillator is slowest at the extremes and fastest through the middle – a sine wave, of which `cubic-bezier(0.45, 0, 0.55, 1)` is the closest cubic approximation. Linear travel reads as a loading bar; a bounce or overshoot reads as a cartoon. The sinusoid is the only one that reads as hardware.

```
.z-scanner {
  position: relative; overflow: hidden;
  block-size: var(--z-scanner-track-h);
  background: var(--z-scanner-track);
}
.z-scanner::after {
  content: ""; position: absolute; inset-block: 0; left: 0;
  inline-size: var(--z-scanner-pip-width);
  background: var(--z-scanner);
  box-shadow: var(--z-glow-red);
  animation: z-sweep var(--z-duration-scanner) var(--z-ease-scanner)
    infinite alternate;
}
@keyframes z-sweep {
  from { left: 0; }
```

```
to { left: calc(100% - var(--z-scanner-pip-width)); }  
}
```

In the terminal. The same primitive, one row tall: a rule of `— (U+2500)` in `--z-scanner-track` with **three consecutive cells** of `— (U+2501)` in `--z-scanner` as the pip, positioned from elapsed time on the same 2400 ms sinusoid and redrawn at 30 fps. Used only for genuinely indeterminate waits — never as ambient decoration, which would burn a redraw budget for nothing.

7.2 Interface motion

PURPOSE	DURATION	EASING
State change (hover, focus)	90–140 ms	<code>--z-ease-standard</code>
Entrances, expansions	220 ms	<code>--z-ease-out</code>
Exits, dismissals	140 ms	<code>--z-ease-in</code>
Larger transitions	380 ms	<code>--z-ease-out</code>

Motion here is **mechanical, not playful**: no bounce, no elastic, no spring overshoot anywhere in the interface. This is a machined object.

7.3 Reduced motion

Under `prefers-reduced-motion: reduce` all durations collapse to 1 ms and **the scanner pip parks at the centre of its track at full opacity**. It is deliberately **not hidden** — the lit slot is an identity element, the travel is the decoration. Users who ask for less motion get the brand without the movement, not a blank space where the brand was.

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7 • Motion

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8 • Voice and tone

Zerado talks to people who live in terminals. The voice is **dry, confident, concrete**: it states facts, respects the reader's time, and never performs enthusiasm. Never bro-ish, never breathless.

ATTRIBUTE	WE ARE	WE ARE NOT
Dry	Understated; the fact is the point	Sarcastic, or bubbly
Concrete	Numbers, names, specifics	Vague, or jargon-padded
Confident	Direct; no hedging, no apologising	Boastful, or timid

1 • After a sync completes

- ✗ 🎉 "Awesome! You crushed it! 247 games synced!!"
- ✓ "247 games. 6 finished. Last played: 3 weeks ago."
- *The second sentence is the product's actual argument; the first buries it under celebration of a database write.*

2 • A price is in budget but above its historical low

- ✗ 🔥 "This game is a STEAL at \$15! Grab it before it's gone!"
- ✓ "\$15, and in budget. It's been \$8 — last June. Maybe wait."
- *Zerado's value is telling you **not** to buy. Fake urgency destroys the trust the feature is built on.*

3 • A Steam sync returns nothing

- ✗ "Oops! Something went wrong 😞 Please try again later."
- ✓ "Steam returned an empty library. Game details are private on your profile — Steam won't share the list until that's public. Settings → Privacy."
- *Name what happened, why, and the next action. "Something went wrong" is the one sentence a terminal user cannot act on.*

4 • Marking a game zerado

- ✗ "Congratulations on this incredible achievement! You're a true champion! 🏆"
- ✓ "Zerado. 41 hours. Sixth this year."
- *The moment carries itself. Three facts land harder than an exclamation mark, and the count is the reward.*

5 • Introducing the community layer

- ✗ "We're SO excited to announce our amazing new social features — coming soon to revolutionise how you share your gaming journey!"

- ✓ "Comments, reviews and public profiles. These run on servers that cost money, so this part will be supported by donation. Not built yet — Phase 4."
(Amended 2026-08-25: the premium-account half was removed — see content/landing-copy.md, Amendment 3.)
- *State the cost before anyone asks. Up front reads as respect; later reads as a catch.*

6 • Explaining why it's a terminal app

- ✗ "Experience the power of a next-generation, blazing-fast CLI-first gaming ecosystem."
- ✓ "It's a text program. It starts instantly, works offline, and your library is one file you own."
- *Three verifiable claims beat six adjectives. This audience checks.*

Standing rules

- **No exclamation marks.** No situation in this product needs one.
- **No emoji in product copy.** Glyphs carry state (§4.3); emoji carry nothing.
- **Never call the user a "gamer".**
- **Say the number.** "41 hours", not "a lot of hours".
- **Portuguese words stay Portuguese.** *zerado* and *sinopse* are explained once, in a clause, on first appearance — then used normally, never re-glossed. A glossary would make the page feel like homework.
- **Never claim what isn't built.** Unshipped phases are marked as phases.

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\$09 9 · One identity, three render targets

The real design problem: this brand must be the same brand in three places with almost nothing technically in common.

	WEB	TERMINAL	PHONE (PHASE 4)
Colour depth	24-bit	256 → 16 → none	24-bit
Layout unit	px, fluid	character cells	dp / pt
Type control	full	one monospaced grid	full, platform metrics
Motion	CSS, 60 fps	redraw budget	platform animation
Logo	Logo.svg	[0]	Logo-mark.svg

The invariants — identical across all three: the four states with colour + glyph + label; **amber common, cyan earned**; the scanner as the only signature motion; the voice; and dark by default.

What is allowed to differ. Web is the most expressive surface — grid horizon, CRT bloom, fluid display type, the full lockup. This is where the brand performs.

Terminal trades expression for density and honesty: no glow, no gradients, no fluid type; hierarchy comes from the monospaced grid, box drawing, spacing and the four-state palette, and it must stay correct at 16 colours and at zero.

The terminal is the product's home — when web and terminal conflict, the terminal wins. Phone follows its platform's conventions — native navigation, gestures and type metrics — while keeping the palette, the state system and the voice. A phone app that fights iOS or Android to look like a terminal is a worse product and a worse advertisement for the brand. **Wear the platform; keep the identity.**

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9 · One identity,
three render
targets

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§10 10 • Governance

The tokens are the source of truth. `tokens.css` and `tokens.json` implement everything in this manual. No surface may hard-code a hex value, a font stack, a spacing step or a duration. If a value is needed and no token exists, add a token — do not type a hex.

Naming has three layers, and they must not be collapsed:

primitive	--z-amber-500	raw value; never referenced by a component
semantic	--z-primary	meaning; what components reference
component	--z-btn-bg-primary	local override; defined at the component

To change something in this brand:

1. Change the token in `tokens.css` and `tokens.json` — same commit.
2. Update the affected section of this manual — same commit. A manual that disagrees with the tokens is worse than no manual.
3. If it touches a colour used for text, **recompute the contrast ratio** and update the table. Do not estimate it.
4. If it touches a **state** colour, **re-run the CVD simulation** for all six pairs. The 11.9 minimum in §4.4 is the floor to protect.
5. If it touches a colour used in the terminal, **re-derive** the ANSI-256 index rather than adjusting the old one by hand.

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The painting is the hero. The brand is the frame.

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ENGINEERED ARTIFACT

DRAWING TITLE
Zerado – Brand Manual
An object from 1984, built for 2030

DISCIPLINE	BRAND IDENTITY	SHEET	13 OF 13	DWG NO.	REV	STATUS
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LEGEND  Ink — text & headings  Canvas — surface  Accent — emphasis  Highlight — rules